UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE

Collective Intelligence & Design Group, DoA
University of Cambridge

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Enthusiastic letter of recommendation for Ms. Aanchala Bhongade

Dear Members of the Review Committee,

I am writing to enthusiastically recommend Ms. Aanchala Bhongade for the program to which she is applying. As a Cambridge University Assistant Professor and Director of the Cambridge Collective Intelligence and Design Group, I have had the privilege of mentoring Aanchala during her undergraduate dissertation research at the University of Cambridge. Our group focuses on advancing social data science methodologies (machine learning and artificial intelligence) to address pressing global challenges in climate and environmental sustainability, a domain in which Aanchala demonstrated both aptitude and passion.

During her time in Cambridge, Aanchala undertook research on projection-based data applications in climate models, with a particular emphasis on CMIP6 and other ensemble models. Her project explored the impacts of heat waves and their intersection with gender disparities in India, with an ambition to scale the analysis to Southeast Asia, which remains an ongoing endeavor of our collaboration. This work required synthesizing publicly available climate datasets, employing statistical analysis, and critically thinking about societal implications. Despite the short duration of her internship, Aanchala exhibited a remarkable ability to engage with challenging material and contribute meaningfully to our research goals.

She actively participated in group discussions, offering thoughtful insights and demonstrating a willingness to engage with diverse perspectives. Her advanced skills in Python and other data analysis tools were evident, but what truly set her apart was her eagerness to learn and adapt, a hallmark of a growth mindset that I believe will serve her well in any academic or professional endeavor.

Aanchala's dedication to her research is further underscored by her ability to transform her undergraduate work into a published article in the Cambridge Journal of Climate Research as the lead author. This achievement speaks volumes about her ability to articulate complex ideas, contribute to scholarly discourse, and successfully navigate high-pressure tasks such as peer review. Although she is already a motivated student, I am confident that with structured guidance and exposure to rigorous training, she has the potential to achieve even greater heights.

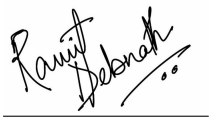
In my opinion, Aanchala would be an excellent candidate for your program. Her combination of technical expertise, intellectual curiosity, and dedication to addressing real-world challenges makes her a strong fit. I am particularly enthusiastic about her prospects for growth, as I believe the structured research environment and advanced analytical training your program offers will further hone her abilities and prepare her for impactful contributions in her field. I am confident that she will be an invaluable asset in both academia and industry.

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Thank you for considering this recommendation. Should you require any additional information, please feel free to contact me at rd545@cam.ac.uk.

Sincerely yours,



Dr. Ramit Debnath

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